

Community Impact Funding

FY 2023-2024 - Year-End Report

Year-End Report Status: Completed / Ready to Submit

North Port Meals on Wheels - Meals on Wheels

2023/2024 Year-End Report

Year-End Reporting Information

Are there any changes in the program that United Way should be aware of (i.e key staff changes, opening or closing program locations, expanding or reduction of services, mergers, funding changes, etc.)

Terry Church, our program director who managed our kitchen operations and fundraising left in the Spring, and we added Sharon Wallace as a Executive Director with a wider responsibility. She left earlier in February 2025, and we are beginning our search for a new Executive Director and determining the correct workload distribution of the staff as we grow and change.

Scott Hedrick has left the board after 6 years to focus on full-time employment but will be consulting as he is able.

Gloria Majerus is new Chairman, Jill Luke is vice chair.

Meal service and funding continues to remain on track, and we have applied to Sarasota County again for funding in FY 2026.

Describe in detail how the program was delivered since application submittal. Include any information about activities and processes of clients moving through the program.

In Fall 2023 when we created our initial proposal for 2024, many residents were still making hurricane repairs and needed our help more than ever. We planned for 10% growth and 38,424 meals served. Spring saw unprecedented growth, and we finished the year delivering a total of 40,235 meals, up almost 14% from 2023, our highest growth ever. We served a total of 324 different individuals compared with a projection of 293.

SUCCESS STORY: Provide an anecdotal story or example of how this program has helped someone.

A couple who are full payment clients: He is 78 years old, and she is 71. He is a disabled Navy vet with COPD, and heart and balance issues and doesn't cook well. She is in cognitive decline. She forgets to turn off the stove and has a hard time measuring recipes. Both were past Meals on Wheels workers. They are thankful to have the service and we are thankful that UWSSC helps cover our overhead so that everyone who needs food is able to get it. We are glad to be able to give back to our former volunteers.

One client is 88 years old with neuropathy and has acid reflux. Her daughter lives with her but works a varied schedule so it is difficult to have a healthy meal prepared for her. She was also a former Meals on Wheels volunteer.

One woman is 89 years old. She uses a walker due to unsteady walking/standing and has dizzy spells and is receiving physical therapy. She was eating mostly microwave meals as it is difficult for her to prepare a meal for herself. She appreciates the freshly prepared meal from us instead along with the daily visits. She is a widow of a National Guardsman.

One woman is 55 years old and has multiple health issues including being an amputee. She lives with her daughter who works full time. She has no transportation and is slightly above 100% poverty level, so she feels "stuck" in the middle of receiving benefits. We've also help connect her to other local agencies that may be able to help her financially, with transportation, medical, etc.

Program Need

Why do you think this program is needed in our community?

We are the only organization in North Port that provides a fresh meal and an in-person visit 6 days per week.

Some companies can provide frozen meals for a short time, and there are other companies who can ship meals, or companies like Grubhub or DoorDash that can deliver a daily meal. The Salvation Army, Awaken Church, and other food pantries have food available to pick up if you're able to get out or send a representative. We refer calls from those who have sufficient mobility to contact one of those organizations.

The North Port Police Department has a phone check-in service to make sure people are well enough to answer the phone each morning. FISH will help people with a ride to the doctor or the grocery store if they do not have access to transportation or can no longer safely drive themselves.

For people who have no transportation, no local family or friends, and very limited funds, we are the only organization that can bring them a fresh meal and a personal visit each day.

Over half of our meals in 2024 were provided below the base cost of \$6.50 to those living below 150% of Federal poverty guidelines. Without the help of UWSSC, we would not have been able to serve everyone who needed our help. We helped 324 different individuals receive a fresh dinner and a friendly safety check. Many of those people have no one else in their life who would check on them or know if they needed emergency help.

Program Description

We are dedicated to preparing and delivering a nutritious meal with a friendly wellness check to adult residents who are unable to prepare a meal for themselves. We charge \$6 per meal, but for those who qualify because their income falls below 150% of poverty (about 50% of our clients), we provide additional financial stability by subsidizing part or all of their meal. The grant money from the United Way goes directly to pay for these subsidized meals.

Our services are available to any adult resident of North Port who is not able to shop for or prepare at least one nutritious meal per day. Adults of ALL incomes and ages may be eligible for meals. Meals on Wheels does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, creed, color, gender, disability, or national origin.

Each day, volunteers prepare and package our meals fresh each morning under strict food safety guidelines in our commercial kitchen. Meals are delivered in a paperboard container that can be warmed in the microwave. After meals are packaged, volunteer drivers deliver the nutritious meal and a wellness check.

What benefits or changes for individuals or populations occurred during or after the implementation of this program.

Each day, each client receives a nutritious meal and a wellness check. For many, they have recently been released from the hospital, or have ongoing medical issues, and the food is an important factor in healing. Having a well-balanced meal without having to work to prepare it relieves physical strain and mental stress while providing daily nourishment and independence of the individual. In addition, having a visitor each day provides socialization and encouragement leading to a boost in mental health which also helps in healing and the desire to improve.

This visit also helps ensure that if there is a health issue, someone is there to notice and notify emergency personnel and family. Many clients have family members who live out of state so the visit also gives them a significant peace of mind knowing that their loved one is checked on. Many other clients have no family and we are the only ones checking on them.

As an extension, by improving the health of our clients, and reducing medical expenses incurred by the Medicare system, more resources are made available to other individuals who need medical aid. Hopefully that reduces costs for all using and paying into the system.

Our main goal is to help each client continue to live independently with dignity for as long as possible, by extending the amount of time that they are able to stay in their own home, a familiar environment, before needing to move to a hospital, family member's home, or assisted living.

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Program Budget and Units of Service

Program Revenue

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Allocation from UWSSC	25,000.00
Gov. Funding - City	0.00
Gov. Funding - County	34,500.00
Gov. Funding - Federal	0.00
Gov. Funding State	0.00
Foundation and Corporate Support	57,535.00
Contributions / Donations	28,138.00
Special Events	27,855.00
Membership Dues Received	
Investment Income	9,698.00
In-Kind Revenue	
Other Income (Click to Itemize)	124,777.00
Client meal payments	124,777.00
Total	307,503.00

Program Expense

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Salaries	108,117.19
Employee Benefits	
Payroll Taxes	
Professional Fees and Contracts	15,467.35
Occupancy (rent, utilities, building & grounds)	62,209.00
Specific Assistance for Individuals	0.00
Supplies/Equipment	120,858.00
Membership Dues / Support to Affiliate Org.	1,249.00
In-Kind Expenses	0.00

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Other Expenses (Click to Itemize)	7,203.00
Write offs, card fees, bank chg	1,370.00
Advertising, vol lunch, staff dev	5,833.00
Total	315,103.54

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Surplus or (Deficit)	-7,600.54

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
% of UWSSC of the Program Budget	8.13

Program Units of Service

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual	Cost per Unit
Individuals Served (non-duplicated)	324.00	972.54
Family Units Served (non-duplicated)	273.00	1,154.23
Matches (non-duplicated)	0.00	0.00
Hours of Service/Care	0.00	0.00
Days/Nights of Care Provided	0.00	0.00
Number of Sessions	0.00	0.00
Meals Served	40,451.00	7.79
Food backpacks distributed	0.00	0.00
Other Service (click to itemize)	0	0.00

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Program ALICE Population and Special Populations

ALICE Population

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Individuals from ALICE Households	138
Individuals from Non-ALICE Households	186
Unknown	0

Special Populations

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actual
Served in Armed Forces	69
Elderly	268
Person with Disabilities	324
Persons Formerly Incarcerated	0
Homeless	0
Living with Family	0
Living with Friends	0
Immigrants/Refugees	0
Other-Click to Itemize	62
Spouse/Widow of Veteran	62
Unknown	0

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Program Client Demographics

Total Clients Served by the Program

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
# of Unduplicated Clients	324
Total	324

Gender

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Males	172
Females	152
Other	0
Unknown	0
Total	324

Age

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
0 - 6 Years	0
7 - 13 Years	0
14 - 17 Years	0
18 - 30 Years	2
31 - 49 Years	10
50 - 64 Years	42
65 - 74 Years	52
75 - 84 Years	101
85+ Years	115
Unknown	2
Total	324

Ethnicity

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Black / African American	6
Asian	1
White / Caucasian	296
Hispanic / Latino	16

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Native Americans	0
Pacific Islander	0
Multi-Racial	0
Eastern European	0
Others	5
Unknown	0
Total	324

Location

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Osprey	0
Laurel	0
Nokomis	0
Venice	0
Englewood	0
North Port	321
Other	3
Unknown	0
Total	324

Income Level

	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
\$0 - \$9,999	17
\$10,000 - \$14,999	38
\$15,000 - \$24,999	70
\$25,000 - \$34,999	13
\$35,000 - \$49,999	4
Unknown	182
Total	324

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Program Outcomes and Performance Measures

Program Outcome

Program Outcome: Improving people's health

Outputs	Output Measurement	Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Number of adults served	# of Clients Served	324
Number of meals and visits provided	# of Clients Served	40,451
Indicators		Jan - Dec 2024 Actuals
Percent of clients who say that "meals have improved my overall quality of life" (based on number of responses)	# Clients Served	144
	# of Clients Achieving	143
	% of Clients Achieving	99.31
Percent of clients who say that "The volunteers who deliver my meals help to brighten my day" (based on number of responses)	# Clients Served	80
	# of Clients Achieving	79
	% of Clients Achieving	98.75
Percent of clients who say that "I look forward to seeing the volunteers who deliver my meals" (based on number of responses)	# Clients Served	77
	# of Clients Achieving	76
	% of Clients Achieving	98.70

What tools did you use to measure these indicators?

We survey our clients to determine if they believe that the statement is true and the service improves their quality of life.

Surveys were printed and delivered with client meals and April menus. Completed surveys were returned by placing them inside the client's cooler for pick up by volunteer drivers when delivering the next meal. In addition, new clients who did not receive the original survey were called and asked the main questions over the phone throughout the year.

Explain any updates to the tools that have been made in the past 12 months.

We used the legal size page with 14 point font again this year so that it was easier to read.

Provide any additional information about the program. For example methodology for enhancing the program performance measures or any barriers and what was learned?

120/140 (86%) clients report reduced isolation through daily human interaction with volunteers from the agency.

144/144 (100%) of participants indicate that they are satisfied or very satisfied with the services provided by the program.

Other important demographics from the survey:

92.9% of clients live here all year

98.7% of respondents are likely to recommend our service to our friend.

77% of clients receive meals 5 or 6 times per week

13% of respondents are over 90 years old

When asked "what do you do on days you do not receive a meal delivery"

28.8% eat leftover meals on wheels

25.0% have someone to prepare a meal for them

8.8% do not eat much on those days

Other comments:

You feed me this wonderful meals. You work hard for all of us for nothing. Thank you.

The meal are very tasty. Very reliable company. The people who deliver the meals are so nice & caring.

If you have questions you can call and talk to someone.

Volunteers are very friendly!